10 AIRLINES / UK + INDIA / MAR TO AUG 2026 VS 2025

Half cut seats.
Half added them.

Who came out ahead after the 2026 shock?

Jet2 carried +8.9% more passengers

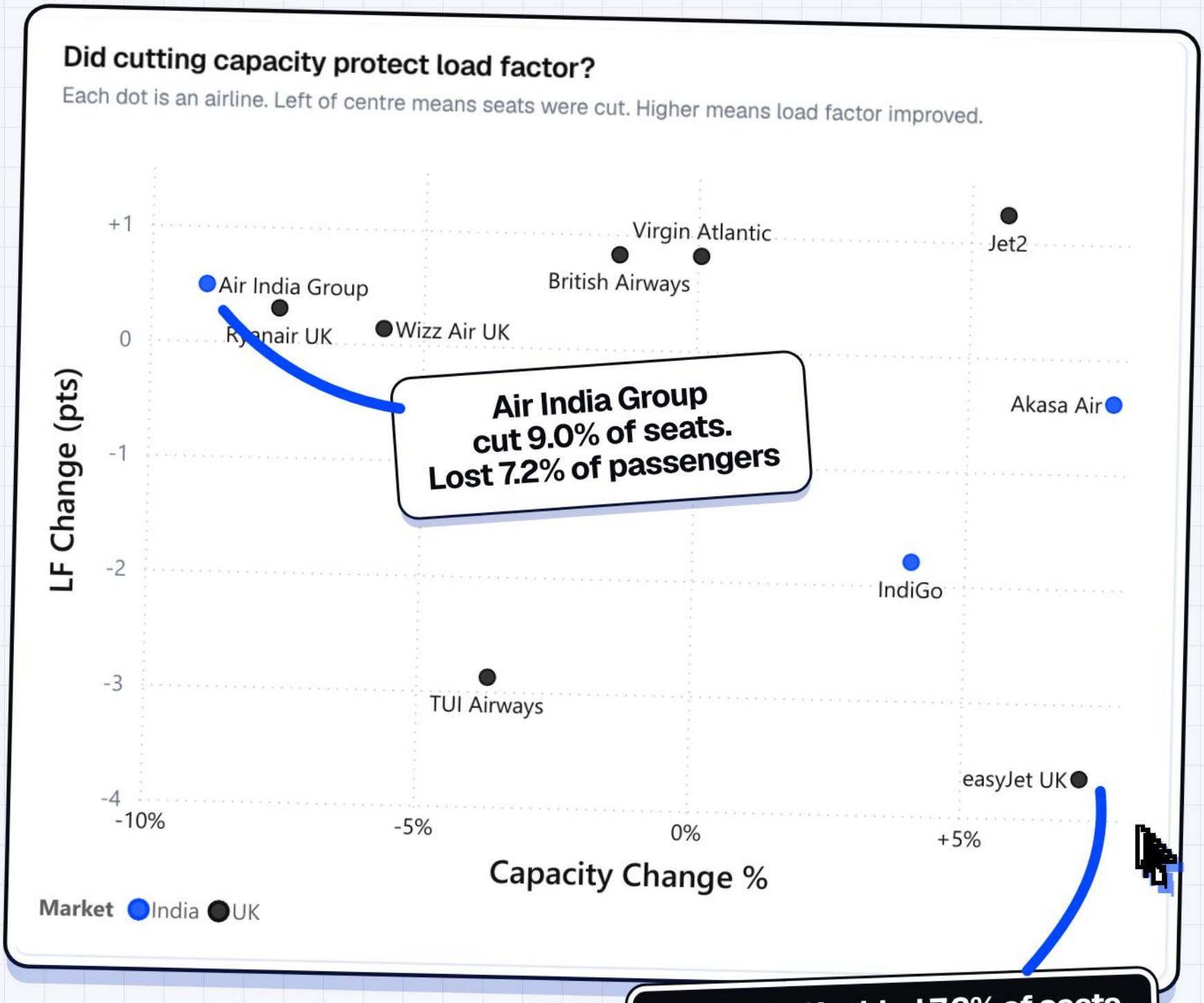


real data, real Power BI

VARESH NIRBHAVNE

Cutting seats protected load factor. It cost passengers.

$$\Delta LF = LF_{2026} - LF_{2025}$$



seats vs passengers:
+0.78 correlation (n=10)

Not just a chart.
The work behind it.

Power BI

Brand playbook

Every airline on the same like for like months, ranked by resilience score.

Brand	Market	Model	Capacity Stance	Capacity Change %	Passenger Change %	LF Change (pts)	Resilience Score	Resilience Rank	Matched Months
Air India Group	India	Full-service	Cut capacity	-9.0%	-7.2%	+0.5	-6.7	10	6
Akasa Air	India	Low-cost	Added capacity	+7.7%	+8.1%	-0.4	+7.7	2	6
British Airways	UK	Full-service	Held capacity	-1.4%	+0.4%	+0.8	+1.2	4	6
easyJet UK	UK	Low-cost	Added capacity	+7.2%	+2.8%	-3.6	-0.9	7	6
IndiGo	India	Low-cost	Added capacity	+4.0%	+0.2%	-1.8	-1.6	8	6
Jet2	UK	Leisure	Added capacity	+5.7%	+8.9%	+1.2	+10.1	1	6
Ryanair UK	UK	Low-cost	Cut capacity	-7.6%	-5.2%	+0.3	-4.9	9	6
SpiceJet	India	Low-cost	No matched data						
TUI Airways	UK	Leisure	Cut capacity	-3.7%	-5.7%	-2.9	-8.6	11	6
Total			**Held capacity**	**+0.7%**	**+0.2%**	**-0.5**	**-0.3**		**6**

SQL

```
sql/02_capacity_vs_load_factor.sql

WITH w AS (
    SELECT b.brand, d.year,
           SUM(f.ask_k) AS ask, SUM(f.rpk_k) AS rpk
    FROM fact_traffic f
    JOIN dim_brand b ON b.brand_id = f.brand_id
    JOIN dim_date  d ON d.month = f.month
    WHERE d.month_num BETWEEN 3 AND 8
      AND d.year IN (2025, 2026)
    GROUP BY b.brand, d.year
)
```

Python

```
notebooks/05_matched_windows.py

def window(r):
    m = r["month"]
    if pd.Timestamp("2026-03-01") <= m <=
pd.Timestamp("2026-08-01") and (r["brand_id"], shift(m,
-1)) in keys:
        return "Shock"
    if pd.Timestamp("2025-03-01") <= m <=
pd.Timestamp("2025-08-01") and (r["brand_id"], shift(m,
1)) in keys:
        return "Baseline"
    return "Other"
```

Star schema.
16 DAX measures.
Matched months.

$$LF = \Sigma\, RPK \,/\, \Sigma\, ASK$$

$$Cap\% = ASK_{26} \,/\, ASK_{25} - 1$$

so seasonality cancels out

Load factor is a guardrail, not the goal.

Cut only where volume is cheap to lose

Ryanair UK and Air India held load factor but lost 5 to 7% of passengers.

Add only where demand is proven

Jet2 grew seats 5.7% and filled them. easyJet UK added 7.2% and lost 3.6 pts.

THE HONEST BIT

Descriptive, not causal. No fare data, so no profit view. UK CAA and India DGCA define load factor slightly differently. SpiceJet left out (no 2025 data).

Built in Power BI, SQL, Python.

github.com/iguesshecodes/airline-shock-2026